

Step	Waterfall — what happens	Waterfall — QA does	Agile — what happens	Agile — QA does
1. Requirements (What does it need to do?)	The whole team writes out every single rule for the button before anything starts	Reads the rules and asks "what if the item is out of stock?" or "what if the user isn't logged in?"	The team writes just enough rules to get started — like "a shopper can click Add to Cart and see it in their cart"	Sits with the team and helps write clear rules that are easy to test later
2. Design (How will it look & work?)	Designers and engineers plan out everything — the button look, the behind-the-scenes code — before writing any code	Reviews the designs and checks for problems — like "what does the error message look like?"	A quick design for just this sprint's work. Build a rough version first and improve it based on feedback	Joins design conversations and starts writing the test plan early, not at the end
3. Code (Build it)	Developers spend weeks building everything according to the plan. Nobody is supposed to change the plan now	Waits for the build to be ready, sets up the test environment, and writes test scripts	Developers build the button in a 2-week sprint. They share code constantly and run automatic checks as they go	Tests new code as soon as it's ready — doesn't wait until the end
4. Test (Does it work?)	A dedicated testing period after all coding is done. QA tries to break the button every way possible and reports bugs	Runs every test on the list — clicking the button, checking the cart updates, testing error messages	Testing happens all the time, not just at the end. Automated tools run hundreds of checks on every update	Runs tests every sprint and also does exploratory testing — just clicking around to find unexpected bugs
5. Deploy (Go live!)	One big launch after everything is done. If something breaks, it's hard to fix because everything was released at once	Does a final check on the live site — clicks Add to Cart to make sure it works for real users	Small updates go live regularly, maybe every 2 weeks. If there's a problem, only a small change needs to be undone	Watches the live site after each release to catch any problems real users are hitting